Abdullah Al Zahid

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Hiring Manager
GO Market Development
Metrolinx

Re: Senior Advisor, GO Market Development

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Senior Advisor position in GO Market Development. I worked at Metrolinx in 2023 as a Transportation Planner in Service Design, and since January 2024 I have been an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto.

The posting asks for someone who can bring large datasets from several sources together to see where travel demand is heading. That is close to what I do at the City. I built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which brought the 2006, 2011 and 2016 Transportation Tomorrow Survey data into one validated source the division now reports from, and I analyze travel and network data to show where capacity falls short and what that means for investment. I review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them, so I am used to asking what growth in a given place means for the network. I also build and maintain the division's road and right-of-way datasets in GIS, and I write the briefing notes that carry findings to senior staff.

At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services and assessed what slow orders would do to service, so I know the network from the operating side. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not done market or consumer analytics, ridership forecasting, or work with mobility and cell phone data, and I have not led technical studies as the senior person on them or managed a stakeholder relationship at this level. I have not used Tableau or Power BI. What I can offer is a sound grounding in the survey data and the GGH network, and I would need to learn the market side of the work.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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